An official website of the United States government Here's how you know

Special Enrollment Periods

You can make changes to your Medicare Advantage and Medicare drug coverage when certain events happen in your life, like if you move or you lose other coverage. These chances to make changes are called Special Enrollment Periods. The types of changes you can make and the timing depend on your life event. If you have questions or need help making enrollment changes, call 1-800-MEDICARE (1-800-633-4227). TTY users can call 1-877-486-2048.

If I qualify for multiple Special Enrollment Periods, can I use more than one at the same time?

If you sign up for Part A or Part B during a Special Enrollment Period because of an exceptional situation (like a natural disaster or emergency), you'll have 2 months to join a Medicare Advantage Plan (with or without drug coverage) or a Medicare drug plan (Part D). Your coverage will start the first [illegible] request to join.

You change where you live

I moved to a new address that isn't in my plan's service area.

I moved to a new address that's still in my plan's service area, but I have new plan options in my new location.

I moved back to the U.S after living outside the country.

I live in, or recently moved out of an institution (like a nursing home or rehabilitation hospital).

I was in jail or incarcerated and have been released.

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You lose your current coverage

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I'm no longer eligible for Medicaid.

I left coverage from my employer or union (including COBRA coverage).

I involuntarily lose other drug coverage that's as good as Medicare drug coverage (creditable coverage), or my other coverage changes and is no longer credible.

I had drug coverage through a Medicare Cost Plan and I left the plan.

I dropped my coverage in a Program of All-inclusive Care for the Elderly (PACE) plan.

Feedback

You have a chance to get other coverage

I have a chance to join other coverage offered by my employer or union.

I have or am enrolling in other creditable prescription drug coverage as good as Medicare drug coverage (like TRICARE or VA coverage).

I enrolled in a Program of All-inclusive Care for the Elderly (PACE) plan.

Your plan changes its contract with Medicare

Medicare takes an official action (called a "sanction") because of a problem with the plan that I'm in.

I'm in a plan that the state recently took over because of financial issues.

Medicare ends (terminates) my plan's contract.

My plan ends its contract with Medicare, or my plan and Medicare agree to end the contract.

My Medicare Advantage Plan, Medicare drug plan, or Medicare Cost Plan's contract with Medicare isn't renewed.

Other special situations

I joined a Medicare Advantage Plan when I was first eligible for Medicare at 65, and within the first year of joining, I decided to switch to Original Medicare.

I have Medicare and Medicaid, or I get Extra Help paying for Medicare drug coverage.

I have Medicare and get full Medicaid benefits.

I found out that I won't be eligible for Extra Help next year.

I can't get premium-free Part A (Hospital Insurance) coverage, and I signed up for Medicare Part B (Medical Insurance) during the Part B General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31).

I have Medicare and Medicaid, or I get Extra Help paying for Medicare drug coverage.

I'm enrolled in a State Pharmaceutical Assistance Program (SPAP).

I'm enrolled in a State Pharmaceutical Assistance Program (SPAP) and I lost SPAP eligibility.

I dropped a Medigap policy the first time I joined a Medicare Advantage Plan and I'm still in a "trial period" and eligible for guaranteed issue of a Medigap policy.

I want to join a plan with a 5-star quality rating.

I'm in a plan that's had a star rating of less than 3 stars for the last 3 years.

I have a severe or disabling condition, and there's a Medicare Chronic Care Special Needs Plan (SNP) available that serves people with my qualifying condition.

Feedback

I'm enrolled in a Special Needs Plan (SNP) and no longer have a condition that qualifies as a special need that the plan serves.

I joined a plan, or chose not to join a plan, due to an error, misrepresentation, or inaction by a federal employee or any person authorized by the Federal government to act on its behalf.

I wasn't properly told by my plan that my other private drug coverage wasn't as good as Medicare drug coverage (creditable coverage).

I wasn't properly told by my plan that I was losing private drug coverage that was as good as Medicare drug coverage (creditable coverage).

I live in the service area of one or more Medicare Advantage Plans or Medicare drug plans with an overall quality rating of 5 stars on Medicare.gov

Other exceptional circumstances

Feedback

There are other events that may qualify you for a Special Enrollment Period. If you think you have an exceptional circumstance that isn't listed on this page call 1-800-MEDICARE (1-800-633-4227). TTY users can call 1-877-486-2048.

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Next Step

Medicare.gov

A federal government website managed and paid for by the U.S. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services.
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